Harvey: a free AI sales agent that runs on your Claude plan

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1. What it is

Harvey (github.com/ethanplusai/harvey) is a free, open-source (MIT) sales agent, about 3,700 GitHub stars. It runs on your own computer in a loop, every 15 minutes by default, and does the boring half of sales:

STEP	WHAT HARVEY DOES
Find	Finds local businesses that match your ideal customer. Default source is **OpenStreetMap: free, no account**. Paid sources are optional (e.g. about $0.37 per 1,000 listings).
Read	Reads each business's website (three web requests, no AI call) and notes something specific about them.
Write	Writes a cold email that mentions that specific thing (e.g. "saw your new sourdough oven").
Reply	Reads the replies, drafts an answer and works the conversation toward a meeting.
Dashboard	Everything is on a dashboard at `localhost:5555`: Today, Outbox, Contacts, Signals.

2. Why there's no API bill

- Harvey uses your **Claude Pro or Max** subscription through Claude Code (or a ChatGPT plan through Codex). No API key, no per-token billing.
- It reads your plan's quota and throttles itself to leave room for your own work (setting `max_daily_claude_percent`, e.g. 80).
- You still need a mailbox to send from: about $7 a month for Google Workspace, ideally on a **separate, secondary domain**.

3. What you need

THING	NOTES
Claude Pro or Max	Claude CLI logged in: `claude login`. Needs a recent CLI (`claude update`).
Python 3.11+	Check `python3 --version`. Mac ships 3.9: `brew install python@3.13`.
A sending mailbox	Gmail/Workspace or Microsoft 365, on a new secondary domain, warmed up before cold email.

4. Setup: the easy way (Claude does it)

`git clone https://github.com/ethanplusai/harvey.git` → `cd harvey` → `claude`, then type: **"set up Harvey for me"**. The repo ships a CLAUDE.md that turns Claude Code into a setup wizard: it installs what's missing, asks what it needs and learns your product.

5. Setup: by hand

#	COMMAND	WHAT IT DOES
1	`python3.13 -m venv .venv && source .venv/bin/activate && pip install -e .`	Install
2	`cp .env.example .env` and fill it in	Mailbox and settings (each one explained inside)
3	`harvey train https://your-company.com`	Learns what you sell from your website
4	`harvey signals --confirm free`	You choose what makes a good prospect
5	`harvey discover`	Finds businesses (free source)
6	`harvey dashboard` then `harvey run`	Opens the dashboard and starts the loop

6. Nothing sends without you

- By default **every email waits in the Outbox for your approval**: A approve, R reject.
- Kill switch: `harvey sending pause` stops everything mid-flight.
- Opt-outs ("no thanks", "STOP", "unsubscribe") are honoured immediately and permanently. Add competitors and existing clients to `compliance.do_not_contact`.

7. The honest limits

- **You are the sender.** Follow cold-email law where your prospects are: CAN-SPAM (US) needs your postal address and a working opt-out; GDPR/PECR (EU/UK) needs a real reason the person would care. India: B2B only, keep it relevant and stop on the first "no".
- OpenStreetMap is thin for businesses without a shop front (roofers, plumbers). Use a paid source if your customers are like that.
- Warm up a new mailbox first, or your emails land in spam. Never send from your main company domain.
- It uses your subscription's usage limits, so a busy day of Harvey means less Claude for you.

Good to know: download only from github.com/ethanplusai/harvey. Not affiliated with Anthropic, OpenAI or the Harvey authors. Everything from the videos: scaleus.in/prompts